which was then devoted to discussing the book. The faculty course coordinator
year grad student relatively close to the students' ages prepared and led this
session.

course typically has 30-35 students in it each year, and each class session is 50
During the final class the students were broken into small groups of 4-5 based
on where they were sitting in the classroom. The discussion leaders prepared a
questions to structure these small group discussions, and incrementally presented
questions to the students while in their small groups. The discussion leaders also
among the student groups during this time, ``eavesdropping" to get hints as to how
conversations were going, interject some new ideas, and make sure that the students
on task.

Approximately 30 minutes were spent in the small groups, leaving sufficient time
sharing with the entire class afterwards. Each group had the opportunity to present
joint answers to the discussion questions in a round-robin fashion, with the
discussion leaders clarifying, summarizing and occasionally challenging the students
throughout. After the small group discussions, the leaders asked the students eleven
questions to assess their individual backgrounds and mindsets, based on points raised by
the book. These were answered in a peer-blind manner (students had to close their eyes
and raise their hands) to prevent peer pressure from influencing their answers.

In the inaugural year of this approach, and in light of its recent 10th anniversary, the faculty thought it fitting to tackle gender issues head-on by having the students read Jane Margolis and Allan Fisher's work Unlocking the Clubhouse: Women in Computing [2]. An additional goal in choosing this particular book was to gain insight as to what extent the issues revealed by the study were still applicable to their students today. They also wanted the male undergraduates to be aware of the issues that have persisted, in order to build a more welcoming community for women. In recent years the participation of undergraduate women in the CS department has increased to 23% of the majors and 44% of the minors across all class years. These numbers continue to rise based on higher ratios of women in the lower years, and the goal is to support that in as many ways as possible. For example, the class of 2016 is currently the largest population of majors, 31% of whom are women.

OUTCOMES

The department introduced the book assignment and discussion session into the freshman seminar course with three goals in mind. In addition, the inaugural book selection introduced a fourth objective, to essentially take the temperature of these freshmen regarding gender issues. While rigorous evaluation of these goals is not possible at this point in time, the results are encouraging enough to warrant further study.

Goal 1: Enhance The Cohort Experience

rior offerings of the M&Ms course indicate that it does provide the freshmen with a cohort experience that had previously been lacking. In standard course ations, getting to know the other freshman majors is usually cited as one of the best cts of the course. Upperclassmen who took the course have been overheard asking